



*Teaching
Genealogists AI™*
Instructor: Sylvia
Vargas

Census Records for Puerto Rican Genealogy

Worksheet 6 — Municipal Research Log

Course Instructor: Sylvia Vargas

Organization: Puerto Rican Genealogy Group

Website: <https://puertoricangenealogy.org>

Purpose

Use this log to plan and document your searches in municipal and local records outside the federal census schedule. Every search — whether it produces results or not — should be recorded. Negative searches are evidence of the limits of the surviving record base and must be documented to meet the Genealogical Proof Standard.

Part 1 — Research Context

Field	Entry
Researcher Name	
Date of Research	
Ancestor(s) Being Researched	
Municipio of Research	
Barrio (if known)	
Time Period of Interest	
Research Question This Search Addresses	

Part 2 — Municipal Record Search Log

Use one row per repository and collection searched. Add rows as needed.

Date	Repository	Collection / Fond	Dates Covered	Municipio / Barrio	Search Terms Used	Result (Found / Not Found / Inaccessible)	Citation (if found)
	Archivo General de Puerto Rico FamilySearch Ancestry.com Municipal Alcaldía UPR Colección Puertorriqueña Other:						

Part 3 — Record Types Checklist

Check each record type for the time period and municipio. Note what survived and where it is held.

Record Type	Time Period Available	Survived? (Y / N / Unknown)	Repository / Access	Notes
Padrones municipales	Varies by municipio			

Record Type	Time Period Available	Survived? (Y / N / Unknown)	Repository / Access	Notes
Property tax rolls (Contribución territorial)	Spanish colonial era forward			
Voter registration lists (Listas electorales)	1897 (Spanish); 1917+ (U.S.)			
WWI draft registration cards	1917–1918		FamilySearch, Ancestry	
WWII draft registration cards	1940–1946		FamilySearch, Ancestry	
Property registry (Registro de la Propiedad)	1880s forward		Regional registry offices	
School enrollment records	U.S. administration forward		Dept. of Education / local	
Status animarum (padrones parroquiales)	Varies by parish		AGPR ecclesiastical fonds	

Part 4 — Negative Search Documentation

For each search that produced no result, record the details here. This is required for GPS compliance.

Date	Repository	Collection Searched	Date Range Searched	Reason No Result (Collection missing / Inaccessible / Not in collection / Other)	Citation / Note for Research File

Part 5 — Evidence Found: Three-Layer Summary

For each document located, complete a brief Three-Layer analysis.

Document Found	Source Type (Original / Derivative / Authored)	Information Quality (Primary / Secondary / Indeterminate)	Evidence Value (Direct / Indirect / Negative)	What It Proves	Conflicts with Other Evidence?

Part 6 — Alternative Source Strategy Summary

Based on your searches, summarize your plan for filling gaps where municipal records do not survive.

Gap Period	Records That Should Exist But Are Missing	Alternative Sources Identified	Search Status

Part 7 — Next Steps

List the specific next actions that follow from this research session.

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Key Repository Contact Information

Repository	Contact / Access
Archivo General de Puerto Rico (AGPR)	https://www.icp.pr.gov/archivo-general/
AGPR Digital Portal	https://www.coleccionesicp.pr.gov/agpr
FamilySearch — Puerto Rico Vital Records	https://www.familysearch.org/en/wiki/Puerto_Rico_Vital_Records
FamilySearch — Puerto Rico Census Wiki	https://www.familysearch.org/en/wiki/Puerto_Rico_Census
WWI Draft Cards (FamilySearch)	https://www.familysearch.org/en/wiki/United_States_World_War_I_Draft_Registration_Cards

Repository	Contact / Access
WWII Draft Cards (FamilySearch)	https://www.familysearch.org/en/wiki/ United_States,_World_War_II_Draft_Registration_Cards
Ancestry.com Military Records	https://www.ancestry.com/search/categories/military/
UPR Colección Puertorriqueña	https://www.upr.edu/biblioteca-rrp/coleccion- puertorriquena/
Archivo General de Indias (PARES)	https://pares.culturaydeporte.gob.es/inicio.html

© 2026 Sylvia Vargas. Teaching Genealogists AI™. All rights reserved.